

FREE GUIDE · 6 PAGES

5-Day Calm & Sleep Reset

5 Natural Ways to Switch Your Brain Off at Night

A simple, lifestyle-led 5-day reset for people whose minds just won't slow down at bedtime. No supplements required. No medical claims. Just five small habits used by people who finally stopped lying awake at 2 a.m.

Inside:

- Why your brain stays "on" long after you close your laptop
- The 90-minute wind-down window most people miss
- Five repeatable habits, one per day
- A 1-page printable for your bedside table

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Why your brain won't switch off

If you've ever fallen into bed exhausted and then suddenly felt wide awake the moment your head hit the pillow — you are not broken. Your nervous system is just still in "day mode."

Most people try to fix sleep with the last 10 minutes of their day. The five habits in this guide work on the **90 minutes before bed** — the window where your body actually decides whether tonight is going to be calm or chaotic.

Try one habit each evening for the next five evenings. You don't have to do them perfectly. Even doing 2 of the 5 well will move the needle.

Important: This is general lifestyle information. It is not medical advice and is not a treatment for any sleep disorder. If you have ongoing sleep problems, please speak to your doctor.

Day 1 — Lower the lights, not the volume

About 90 minutes before bed, dim the lights in the room you're sitting in by at least half. Lamps over ceiling lights. Warm bulbs over white. Your eyes send 'it's evening' signals to your brain through light intensity, not sound. People are often surprised how quickly the body softens when the room stops shouting at it.

Day 2 — The 10-minute brain dump

Grab a notebook. Set a 10-minute timer. Write down everything that's still spinning in your head — tasks, worries, ideas, half-finished conversations. Don't organise it. Don't fix it. Just get it out of your head and onto paper. The point is not the list. The point is telling your brain, "I've heard you. We can deal with this tomorrow."

Day 3 — Move the phone out of arm's reach

Tonight, charge your phone in a different room — or at least on the other side of the bedroom. If you use it as an alarm, buy a R150 alarm clock. The phone is the single most common reason adults stay mentally 'on' past midnight. Distance is the cheapest sleep upgrade you'll ever make.

Day 4 — Warm shower, cool room

About 60 minutes before bed, take a warm shower for 5–10 minutes. Then sleep in a cool room. The drop in body temperature after the shower mimics the natural temperature dip your body uses to fall asleep. It's a simple physical cue, not a trick.

Day 5 — One slow exhale at a time

In bed, lights off. Breathe in for 4 seconds. Breathe out slowly for 6–8 seconds. Repeat for 2–3 minutes. Long exhales activate the part of your nervous system that says "you are safe, you can rest now." If your mind wanders, just come back to the next out-breath. That's it.

Your 1-page bedside printable

Stick this on your bedside table. Tick one box each evening this week.

☐ Day 1 — Lights down 90 minutes before bed
☐ Day 2 — 10-minute brain dump on paper
☐ Day 3 — Phone charges in another room
☐ Day 4 — Warm shower, cool bedroom
☐ Day 5 — 4-in / 6-out breathing in bed

Most people sleep meaningfully better by Day 3 — not because of any one thing, but because the nervous system finally gets a consistent "day is done" signal for several evenings in a row.

Want a little extra help winding down?

Some people find that a calm-support botanical lozenge fits naturally into the 90-minute wind-down window — especially around Days 3–5 of this reset.

APLGO NRM is a plant-based lozenge our community uses as part of a daily metabolic and balance routine. It is sugar-free, GMO-free, and is not a treatment for any medical condition. We mention it here only because some readers ask, "is there anything natural I can take?" — not as part of this 5-day plan.

If you want to learn more about NRM (price, shipping, FAQs), the page is here:

onlinecourseformlm.com/shop/nrm

If not — that's completely fine. The 5-day reset works on its own. Sleep well. ■

— The Online Course for MLM team

Questions? Reply to any email in this series and we'll read it.